A-A-53197
30 September 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TUBE, FEEDING (Enteral, 12 French)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This commercial item description covers a sterile, disposable, weighted feeding tube designed for enteral feeding.

Salient characteristics:

Material. The feeding tube shall be fabricated from transparent thermoplastic polyurethane (tpu) or silicone rubber. The stylet shall be fabricated from martensitic corrosion-resistant steel. The end connector, end cap and stylet handle shall be fabricated of a suitable rigid plastic. The weight shall be fabricated with tungsten.

Characteristics. The tube shall be 42 to 48 inches in length, and shall be 4 ± 1/4 millimeters (12 French) in diameter at the widest point of the insertable length. The tube shall have two circumferential placement markings. The first marking shall be a single stripe, and shall be located 24 ± 3/4 inches from the distal tip. The second marking shall be a set of double stripes, and shall be located 32 ± 1 inches from the distal tip.

The distal end of the tube shall be weighted with 4 to 5 grams of Tungsten. The tip shall completely enclose the metal, and shall be well rounded at the extreme distal tip. The tip may be attached or an integral part of the tube.

The tube shall have two to four oval feeding eyes. The eyes shall be divided on diametrically opposite sides of the tube. The most distal eye shall be placed a nominal 1-1/2 inches from the tip. The eyes shall have an open cross-sectional area of at least 80 per cent that of the lumen of the tube.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The tube shall have a radiopaque stripe throughout its insertable length. The stripe need not extend onto the weighted tip.

The proximal end of the tube shall be an integral or attached standard funnel connector. The connector shall have an integral or attached plug which makes a mechanically secure connection with the connector.

The tube shall be furnished with an insertable wire stylet. The stylet shall be manufactured of braided wire, and shall be blunt and free from sharp protusions throughout its length. The stylet shall have a handle on the proximal end, and shall be of sufficient length to reach the distal end of the tube when inserted into the lumen of the tube.

The tip shall be lubricated with a pharmaceutical grade lubricant.

Instructions. An instruction sheet detailing the proper use of the feeding tube shall be provided with the device. The sheet shall also include a description of the insertion markings.

Workmanship. The feeding tube shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

PRODUCT QUALITY LEVEL.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that the design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing ten individually packaged sterile tubes, as specified, constitutes one unit. The individual package shall be a sealed, peel-open type container capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless the package is damaged or opened.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. Tubes shall be examined for compliance to specification requirements. Examination shall include:

dimensions
eyes free from flash or other obstructions
eyes free from sharp edges
insertable portion free from sharp edges or protusions
plug makes secure fit in connector
markings are present and legible
placement markings are as specified

Sampling for examination. Sampling shall be level S-4 with an AQL of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one feeding tube. Tests shall be performed on end items after sterilization.

Sterility. Tubes shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the United Stated Pharmacopia (USP).

Biocompatibility. Material used to manufacture the tube shall be tested in accordance with the requirements of the USP for class IV plastics.

Certification of biocompatibility. A certificate of compliance, stipulating offered items meet the requirements specified herein, shall be acceptable, provided that the contractor has supplied acceptable items to the Government within the past three years, and that there has been no changes to material, formulation and method of processing. The certificate shall include the current contract number and applicable NSN, the date of the testing, the test method and results, and a title of the person evaluating test results, and a statement to the effect that material formulation and processing have not changed since the testing was performed.

Tensile strength and Elongation. Tubes shall be tested for tensile strength and ultimate elongation in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard D412. Silicon tubes shall have an ultimate elongation of 600% minimum and a tensile strength of 1200 psi minimum. Polyurethane tubes shall have an ultimate elongation of 500% minimum and a tensile strength of 4000 psi minimum. The sampling level shall be S-1 with an AQL of 1.0.

Security of assembly. Tubes which have an attached tip and/or attached funnel connector shall be tested for security of assembly as follows. Cut the tubing six inches from the attached component. Secure the tubing to an immobile vice or clamp, and subject the attached component to an 8 pound tensile force. Any component which separates shall constitute a test failure. Sampling shall be S-2 with AQL of 1.0.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Metric product. Product manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerance specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-247-7154	TUBE, FEEDING, Enteral 12 Fr, Radiopaque

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 52268

Project No. 6515-4141

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53197	TUBE, FEEDING (Enteral, 12 French)

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

(FOLD ON THIS LINE) CUT ALONG THIS LINE)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for u submitting comments and suggestions for improvements All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed In block 5 be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document If block 7 is filled out an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

(Fold along this line)

Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN DPSC-RSTE
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:16Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.